

Giuliano Formisano

Department of Political Science, University of Zurich
giuliano.formisano@uzh.ch — <https://giulianoformisano.github.io/>

Last Update: August 31, 2026

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

- **University of Zurich - Department of Political Science** Zurich, CH
Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Digital Technology & Politics 2025 - Present
- **University of Oxford - Department of Politics & IR** Oxford, UK
Research Associate, AuthLib project 2023 - 2026

EDUCATION

- **University of Oxford** Oxford, UK
Doctor of Philosophy (PhD); Social Data Science 2021 - 2025
Courses: Data Analytics, Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing, Networks, Statistics
Thesis: Exploring Online Polarisation in the US: A Computational Social Science Approach
Assessors: Prof Sara Hobolt (LSE), Prof Mohsen Mosleh (Oxford)
- **Yale University** - Department of Politics New Haven, USA
Visiting Scholar; Advisor: Prof Joshua Kalla Spring 2024
Courses: Applied Machine Learning, Social Network Analysis, Game Theory
- **Sciences Po, Paris** - Centre for European Studies and Comparative Politics Paris, FRA
Visiting Scholar; Advisors: Dr Joost de Moor & Prof Caterina Froio Spring 2023
- **University of Oxford** Oxford, UK
Master of Philosophy (MPhil); Political Science 2019 - 2021
- **University of Exeter** Exeter, UK
Bachelor of Arts (BA); Politics and International Relations 2016 - 2019

PEER-REVIEWED RESEARCH

* = Equal contribution.

5. **Formisano, G.**, Froio, C., & Castelli Gattinara, P. (conditionally accepted) Automating Protest Event Analysis: A Transformer-Based Framework for Multilingual Classification of Newspaper Articles. *Political Science Research & Methods*.
4. **Formisano, G.***, Hine, E.*, Juneja, P., Laitila, J., Novelli, C., Chiu, E., Dejanikus, E., Levin, M., Schroder, T., West, A., & Floridi, L., (2026) Editorial Governance Under Pressure: Wikipedia's Revert Dynamics During the 2024 US Election. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*.
3. **Formisano, G.**, Friedrichs, F., Schaffner, F., & Stoehr, N. (2026) Populism and Governmentalism as Thin-Centered Ideologies: Emotions and Frames on Social Media. *European Journal of Political Research*, 65(2), pp. 607–626.
2. Novelli, C., **Formisano, G.**, Juneja, P., Sandri, G., & Floridi, L. (2024) Artificial Intelligence for the Internal Democracy of Political Parties. *Minds and Machines*, 34(36), pp. 1-26.
1. Friedrichs, J.*, Stoehr, N.*, & **Formisano, G.*** (2022) Fear-Anger Contests: Governmental and Populist Politics of Emotion. *Online Social Networks and Media*, 32, pp. 1-13.

WORKING PAPERS

* = Equal contribution.

7. Errichiello, E.*, & **Formisano, G.***, Speaking Security Without Authority: Digital Capital and Security Influencers. *Revise & Resubmit*.
6. Novelli, C., Argota Sánchez-Vaquerizo, J., Cyr, J., **Formisano, G.**, Dougall, S., Sandri, G., and Floridi, L., Fake Plastic Voters: When Political Parties Can Use AI-Simulated Focus Groups. *Revise & Resubmit*.

5. **Formisano, G.**, Henry, C., Proma, A.M., Hoes, E., Klüser, J., Donnay, K., & Gilardi, F., Indirect Effects of Content Moderation Errors: A Chatroom Experiment with AI Agents. *Under review*.
4. **Formisano, G.**, Lattmann, J.F., & Friedrichs, J., Communication Feedback Between Politicians and Citizens on Social Media.
3. Clemente, A.*, & **Formisano, G.***, Mind the Bricks: Fairness Beliefs and Local Housing Inequality in the UK. - *Winner of the 2025 Elinor Ostrom Award by the Italian Political Science Association*.
2. **Formisano, G.**, Kosmidis, S., & Theocharis, Y., Measuring Online Polarisation: A Supervised Machine Learning Approach.
1. **Formisano, G.**, The Network Dynamics of Online Polarisation in the US.

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

2. Clemente, A., & **Formisano, G.**, How Collective Efficacy Shapes Attitudes Toward Inequality. *Funded by the Inequality Research Fund, University of Zurich*.
3. **Formisano, G.**, & Valentim, V., Public Responses to Violations of Different Political Norms.
1. Whitefield, S., Kosmidis, S., & **Formisano, G.**, Programmatic and Emotional Appeals of Illiberal Parties. *Presented at 2025 EPSA and APSA Conferences*.

CONFERENCES

- European Political Science Association/Society (EPSA/S): 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
- American Political Science Association (APSA): 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
- Swiss Political Science Association: 2026
- CompText: 2025, 2026
- PolMeth Europe: 2025

WORKSHOPS, PRE-CONFERENCES, AND TALKS

- 2026 (past and scheduled):
 - APSA Pre-Conference in Political Communication, Boston
 - Democracy Under Pressure Workshop, ETH Zurich
 - Democracy and AI, University College Dublin
 - AUTHLIB Final Conference, Budapest
- 2025:
 - Polarization Workshop, MIT
 - Digital Democracy Workshop, University of Zurich
 - The Future of Social Media Research Workshop, University of Oxford
 - APSA Pre-Conference in Political Communication, Vancouver
 - Representation in Divided Democracies Workshop, ETH Zurich
 - EPSA Pre-Conference in Large Language Models, Madrid
 - Social and Moral Norms Workshop, University of Oxford
- 2024:
 - Harnessing LLMs in Political Science Workshop, Trinity College, Dublin
 - Work in Progress Seminar, Data Ethics Center, Yale University
 - AI and Algorithms in Government Conference, Yale University
 - Pre-Publication Workshop, SciencesPo, Paris
- 2023:
 - Theory Research Cluster, London School of Economics
 - Research in Progress Seminar, Department of Politics, University of Oxford
 - APSA Pre-Conference in Political Economy, Los Angeles
- 2022:
 - DPhil Seminar, Oxford Internet Institute, University of Oxford
 - DPhil Work in Progress Workshop, Department of Politics, University of Oxford
 - PhD Work in Progress Seminar, European University Institute
 - 17th Annual Doctoral Conference/Workshop, Central European University

TEACHING

PG = Postgraduate level; UG = Undergraduate level

- **University of Zurich, Department of Political Science** Zurich, CH
Course Convenor:
 - Computational Political Science Methods (PG/UG) *Fall 2025-2026*
 - Political Campaign Strategy (UG) *Fall 2025-2026*
 - Digital Politics (UG) *Spring 2025-2026*
- **Yale University, Institution for Social and Policy Studies** New Haven, USA
Workshop on Fine-tuning, Evaluating and Employing Large Language Models *Spring 2024*
- **University of Oxford, Oxford Internet Institute** Oxford, UK
Teaching Assistant:
 - Digital Social Research Method: Statistics Core (PG) *Fall 2022*
 - Digital Era Politics and Government (PG) *Spring 2022*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- **AuthLib Project; CEU Democracy Institute & EU Horizon 2020** Oxford, UK
Research Assistant; Advisors: Prof(s) Stephen Whitefield & Spyros Kosmidis *2022 - 2023*
Constructed a research design to collect a large textual dataset of public opinion, train a machine learning classifier for illiberal behaviour, and analyse data.
- **Sciences Po; Centre for European Studies and Comparative Politics** Remote, Paris, FRA
Research Assistant; Advisor: Prof Caterina Froio *2022 - 2023*
Developed a machine learning classifier to classify protest events based on a large dataset of human-coded newspaper articles from European multilingual sources.
- **University of Oxford** Oxford, UK
Research Assistant; Advisor: Prof Spyros Kosmidis *Spring 2022*
Applied transfer learning to conduct a sentiment analysis based on roBERTa, and designed and implemented sequence classification based on a pre-labelled corpus of 2,000 political tweets.

Research Assistant; Advisor: Dr Vicente Valentim *Spring 2022*
Built large Twitter posts dataset, applied and validated sentiment analyses for multilingual text.

Research Assistant; Advisor: Prof Joerg Friedrichs *Fall 2020*
Programmed web-scraping tools to build large online electoral datasets. Coded data with pre-trained machine learning classifiers. Analysed data via time-series analyses.
- **University of Exeter** Exeter, UK
Research Assistant; Advisor: Prof Clare Saunders *2018 - 2019*
Produced literature review on affective polarisation. Coded and analysed interview transcripts about the 2015 UK Badger Culling policy, involving governmental actors, police, stakeholders and citizens.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **UK Labour Party** Remote, London, UK
Research Associate *2024 - 2025*
Collaborated with Labour's Data Science and Communication teams, using machine learning, natural language processing, and causal inference methods.
- **Piave Digital Agency** Remote, Bologna, IT
Research Associate *2022 - 2023*
Collected and analysed public opinion data on Stefano Bonaccini (President of Emilia Romagna Regional Council) during the Democratic Party's 2023 leadership elections.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- Admissions committee member, Master in Comparative and International Studies (MACIS), University of Zurich and ETH Zurich. 2026 - Present
- Referee for: *Political Behaviour*; *Legislative Studies Quarterly*; *PLOS One*; *International Journal of Comparative Sociology*; *Minds & Machines*; *Journal of Information Technology & Politics*; *Theory & Society*.

HONOURS AND AWARDS

- IPZ Research Grant, University of Zurich (with Valentim, V.), CHF 10,000 2026
- Inequality Research Fund, University of Zurich (with Clemente, A.), CHF 6,050 2025
- Elinor Ostrom Prize, Italian Political Science Association (with Clemente, A.), EUR 500 2025
- Nuffield College - Research Grant, approx. £6,000 Spring 2025
- Nuffield College - Yale Exchange Programme, approx. £18,000 Spring 2024
- ESRC Overseas Institutional Visit Fund, £4,000 Spring 2024
- ESRC and Nuffield College Travel Grants, approx. £10,000 2021-2025
- ESRC Advanced Quantitative Scholarship (Tuition fees and stipend) 2021 - 2025
- Nuffield College DPhil Scholarship (College fees) 2021 - 2025
- Victor Wiseman Prize, University of Exeter - Best grade overall and dissertation 2019

LANGUAGES AND SKILLS

- **Languages:** Italian (native), English (bilingual), French and Spanish (professional proficiency), German (beginner)
- **Coding:** Python, R, SQL, SPSS, PHP, HTML, CSS
- **Key libraries:** PyTorch, TensorFlow, scikit, Keras, NLTK, NetworkX, tidyverse, ggplot, dplyr, tidyr
- **Platforms:** Anaconda, VSCode, RStudio, Docker, AWS, Git/GitHub, Google Console & Workspace
- **Publishing:** Git/GitHub, Rmarkdown, Jupyter Notebooks, L^AT_EX, DataVerse

REFERENCES

- Prof Fabrizio Gilardi, Political Science Department, University of Zurich: gilardi@ipz.uzh.ch.
- Prof Spyros Kosmidis, Department of Politics, University of Oxford: spyros.kosmidis@politics.ox.ac.uk.
- Prof Ralph Schroeder, Oxford Internet Institute, University of Oxford: ralph.schroeder@oii.ox.ac.uk.